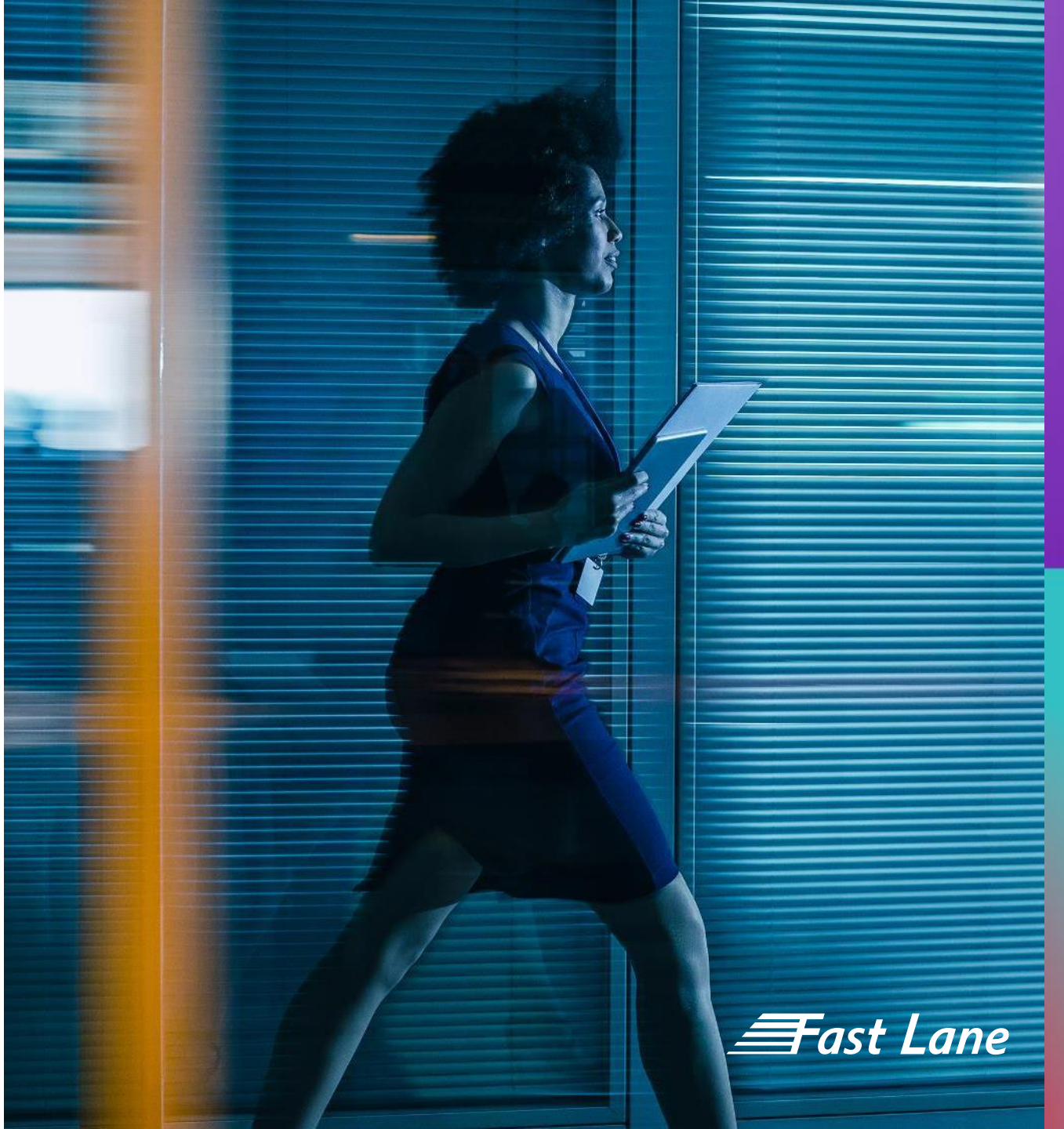
Fast Lane Group

Worldwide Education & Professional Services

Microsoft Solutions Partner

Microsoft Cloud Training Services



www.flane.de | © 2026 Fast Lane Institute for Knowledge Transfer GmbH

— AGENTIC AI: FROM STRATEGY TO **PRODUCTION.**

Alexander Kastil

Full stack, from enterprise software to agentic AI. Since 1996

AI at Work
Value discovery, KPI mapping and roadmap

Enterprise AI
Governed multi-agent systems on Microsoft Copilot and Foundry

Agentic Software Engineering
Harness architecture for Claude Code and GitHub Copilot

Team Enablement
AI driven content production and delivery

integrations.at
alexander.kastil@integrations.at

github.com/alexander-kastil
linkedin.com/in/alexander-kastil

INTEGRATIONS

AGENTIC AI CONSULTING · VIENNA



Microsoft CERTIFIED — AGENTIC AI BUSINESS SOLUTIONS ARCHITECT — ★★★

Microsoft CERTIFIED — AZURE AI APP AND AGENT DEVELOPER — ASSOCIATE ★★

Microsoft CERTIFIED — DEVOPS ENGINEER — EXPERT ★★★

SCAN TO CONNECT
integrations.at

MODULE 2

Microsoft 365 Copilot Cowork

Delegate multi-step work across Microsoft 365

Automate Business Processes with Copilot Studio and Copilot Cowork



01

Getting Started with Cowork

What Cowork is, setup, and how a task runs

02

Understanding Skills: Built-in Skills & the Side Panel

The built-in catalog and the Workspace panel

03

Creating Custom Skills with SKILL.md

Your own skills in plain language

04

Scheduled Prompts & Event-Driven Tasks

On a schedule or when a message arrives

05

Extending Cowork with Plugins

Outside data and expertise from plugins

06

Human-in-the-Loop: Approving Actions & Staying in Control

Approvals, risk levels, and governance

Microsoft 365 Copilot Cowork

Delegate multi-step work across Microsoft 365

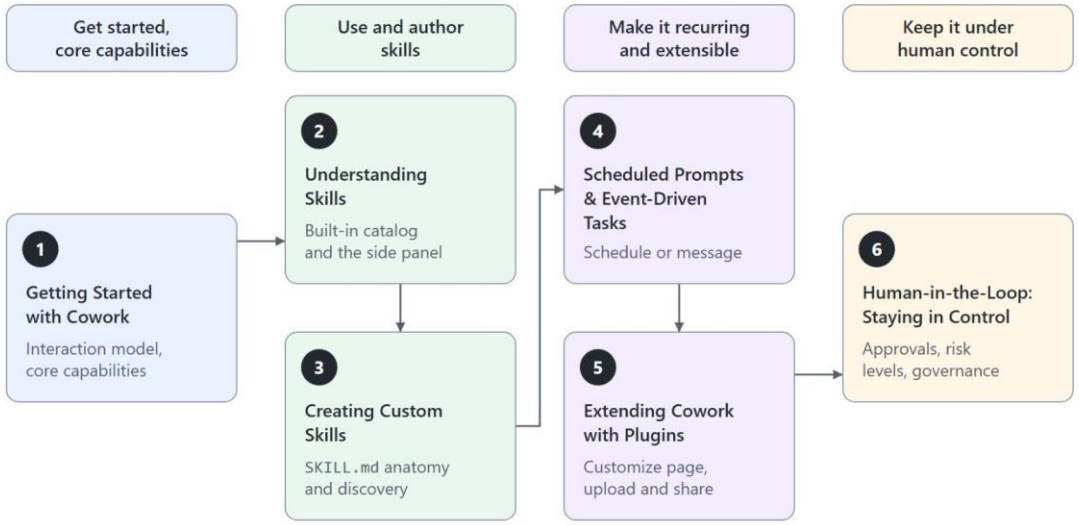
- **Delegate** an outcome in plain language, and Cowork plans and runs the steps
- **Extend** it with skills, schedules and plugins
- **Approve** before anything is sent or saved



Overview

The path through six topics

- **Get started**: what Cowork is, how it differs from Chat, tenant setup and how a task runs
- **Use and author skills**: the built-in catalog, the Workspace panel and your own `SKILL.md`
- Make the work **recurring** with scheduled prompts and event-driven tasks
- Make it **extensible** with plugins that add external data and expertise
- Keep it under **human control** with approvals, risk levels and governance



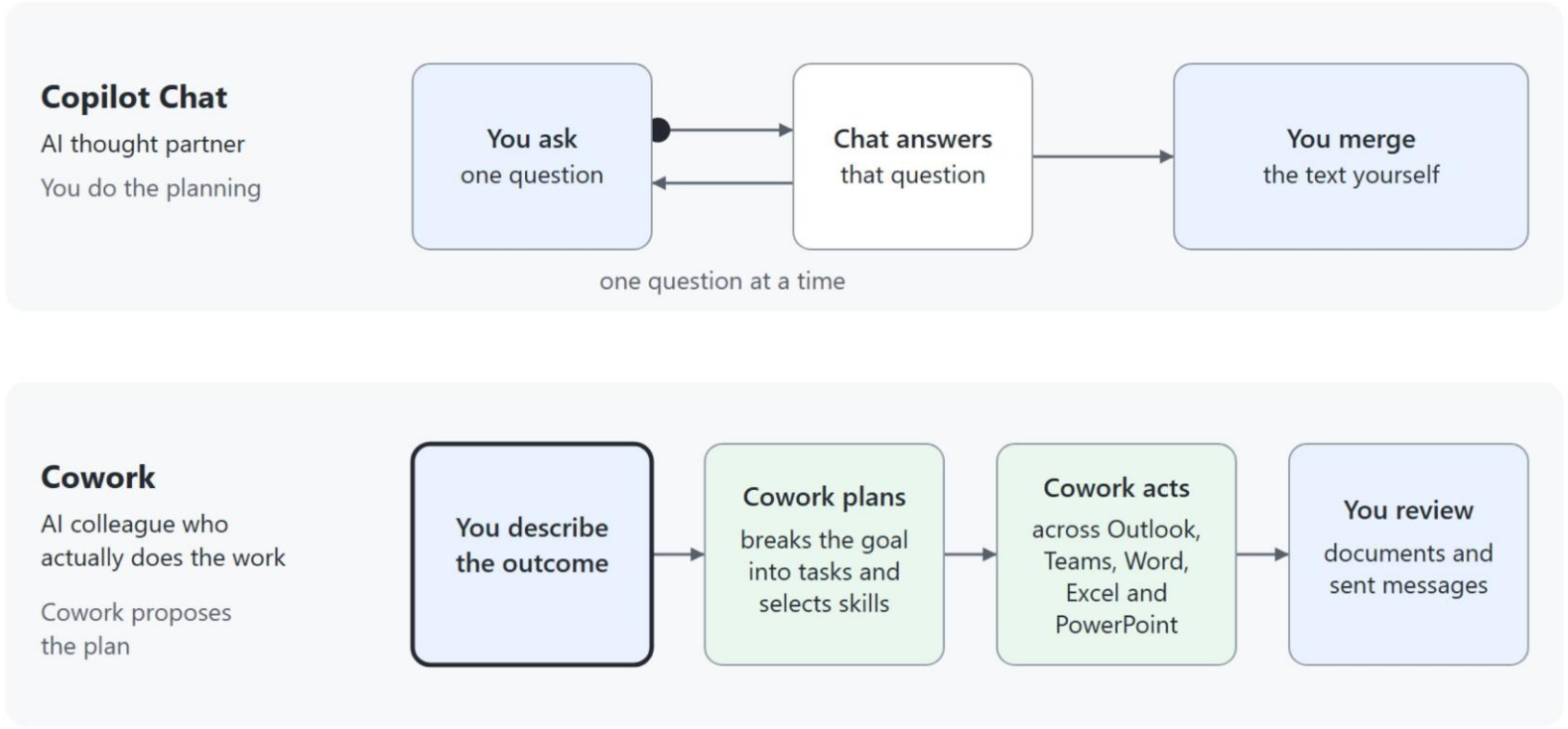
01

Getting Started with Cowork

What Cowork is, setup, and how a task runs

Cowork and Copilot Chat

Who plans the work

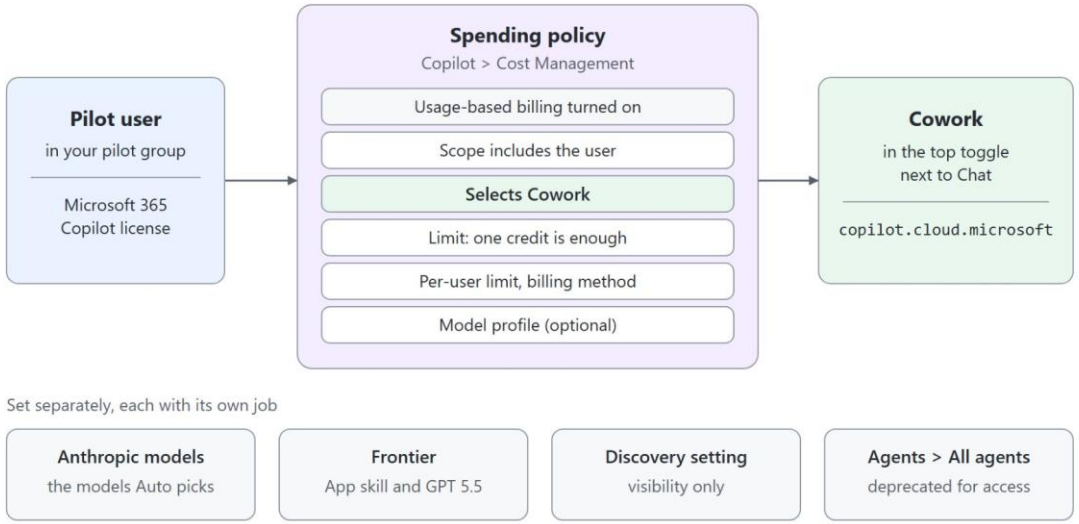


- In Chat you ask **one question at a time**; in Cowork you **describe the outcome**, and it plans and acts across Microsoft 365

Setting up Cowork access

A spending policy that selects Cowork

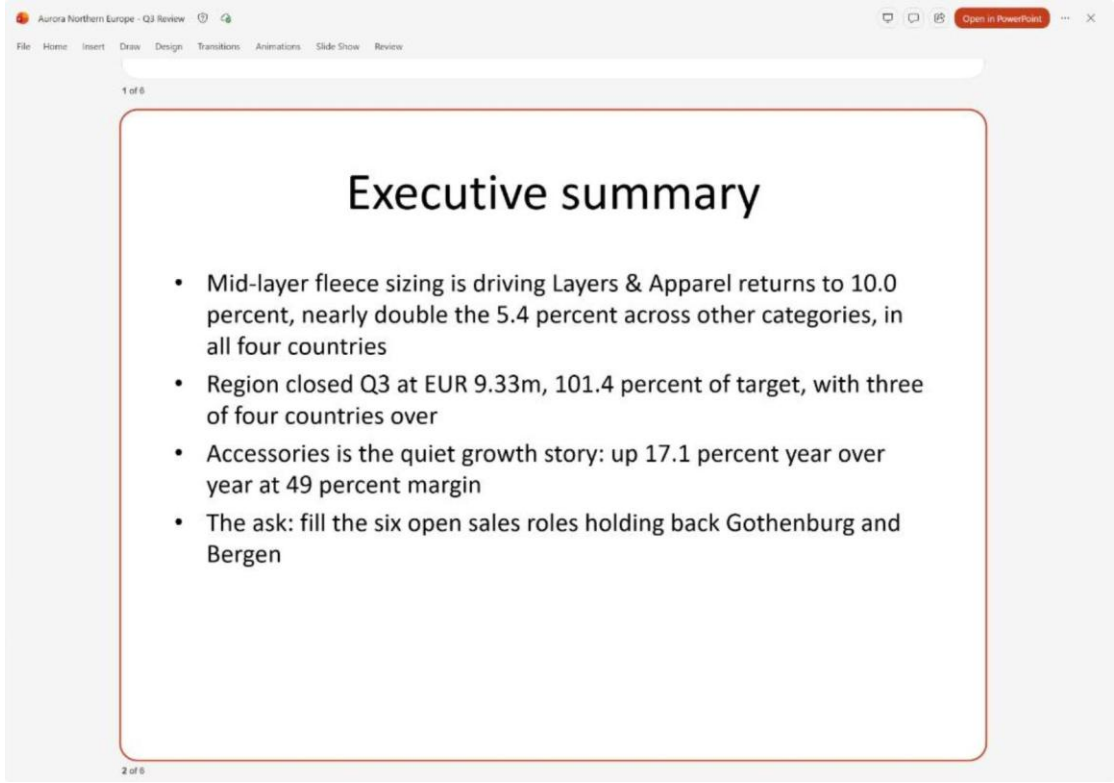
- Every pilot user and the setup admin need a **Microsoft 365 Copilot license**
- Turn on **usage-based billing** under Copilot > Cost Management
- A **spending policy** scoped to the pilot group with Cowork selected grants access; one credit is enough
- **Anthropic models** and **Frontier** are optional for access
- The **discovery** setting controls visibility only



A typical Cowork interaction

The Q3 review deck from brief to approved send

- **Describe** the outcome: three attached files and one brief for the Q3 review
- **Watch** the numbered plan, then the steps as Cowork builds the deck
- **Steer** the plan: open with the fleece returns, close with the six open roles
- **Approve** the send at a Send draft? card marked Medium risk
- **Review** the deck under Output, with speaker notes saved in the same file



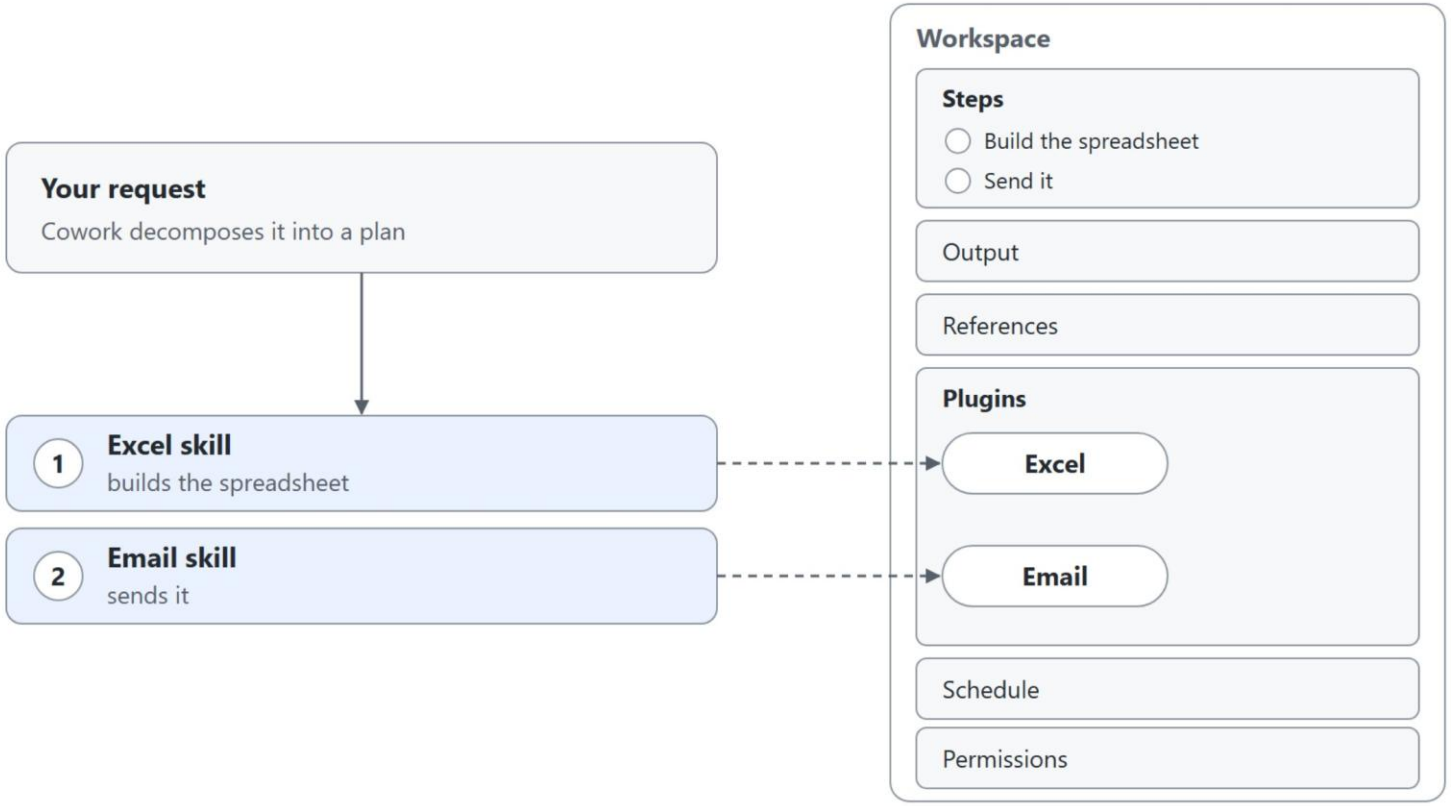
02

Understanding Skills: Built-in Skills & the Side Panel

The built-in catalog and the Workspace panel

Built-in skills and the Workspace panel

Cowork picks the skills; the panel shows them at work

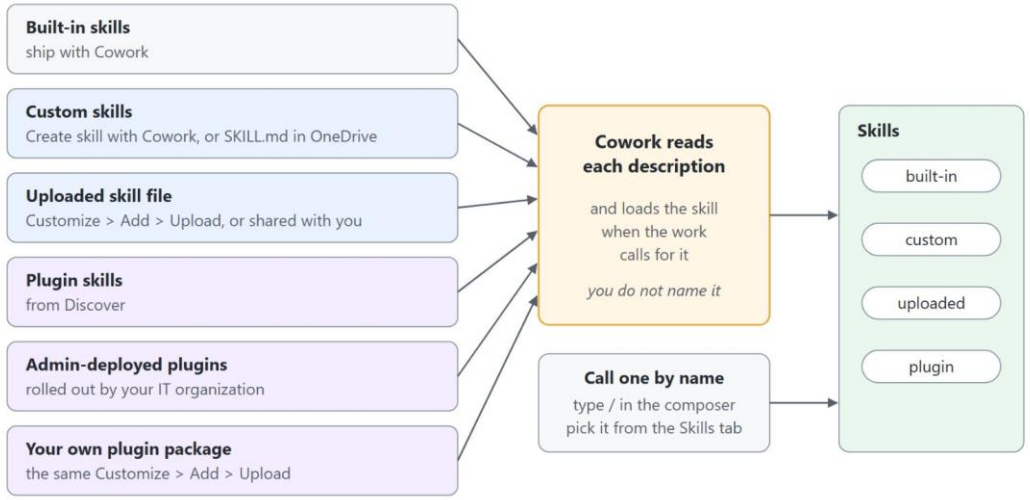


- Each skill Cowork loads for a step appears under **Plugins** in the Workspace panel, beside Steps, Output and References

Where skills come from

Built-in, custom and plugin skills load the same way

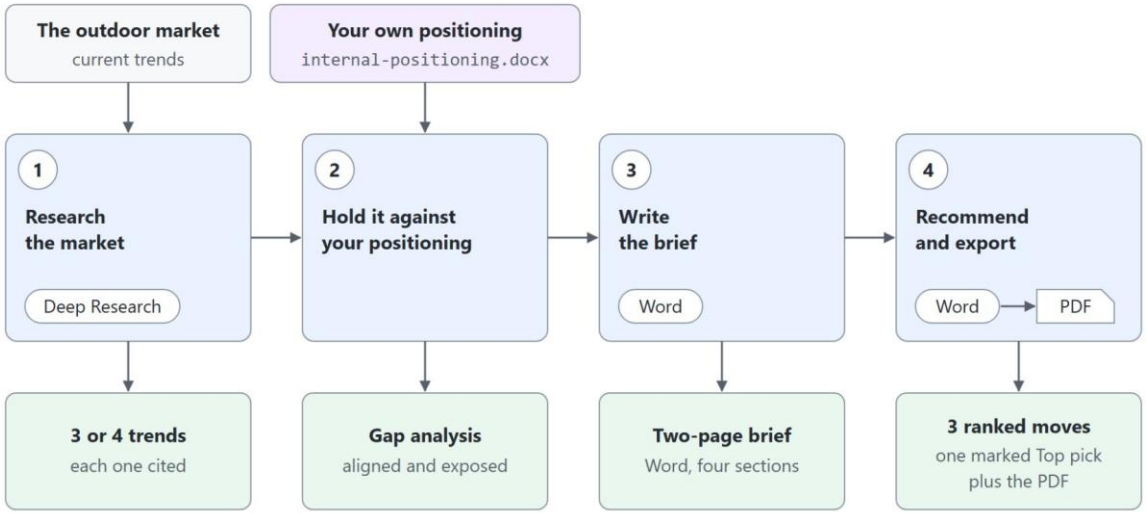
- **Create** a skill with Customize > Add > Create skill with Cowork, or as a `SKILL.md` in OneDrive
- **Upload** a skill file with Customize > Add > Upload, or use one a colleague shares
- **Plugins** come from Discover, from your IT organization, or as your own uploaded package
- Cowork **reads each description** and loads the skill when the work calls for it
- Type **/** in the composer to call a skill by name from the Skills tab



Producing a market brief

Deep Research, your positioning, then a Word brief and a PDF

- **Deep Research** surveys the European outdoor market in a background task of about four minutes
- `internal-positioning.docx` turns the trends into an **aligned and exposed** gap analysis
- The **Word** skill writes AW26 Market Brief - Aurora Outdoor in four sections
- **Recommendations** rank three moves and mark one Top pick
- One background task saves the `.docx` and exports the **PDF** for leadership



03

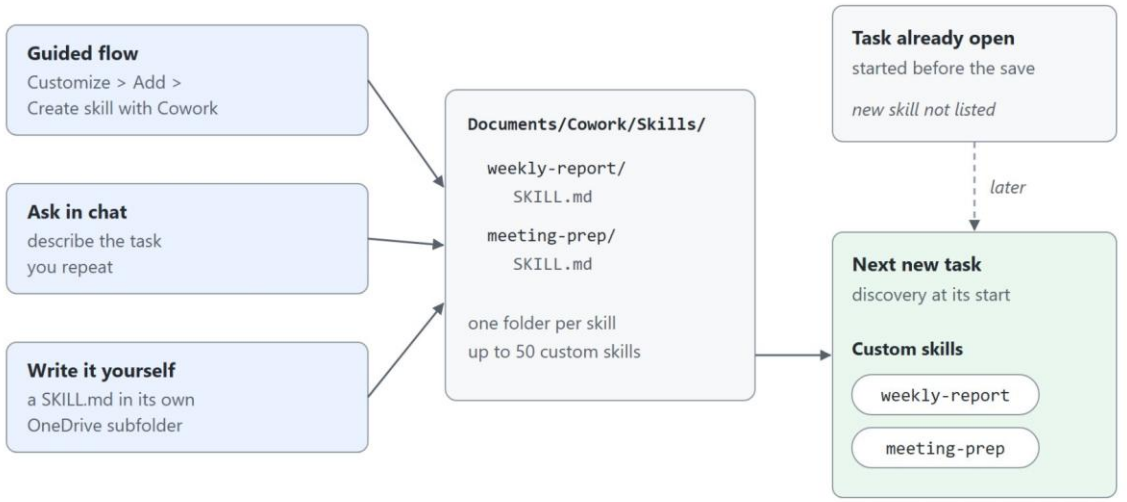
Creating Custom Skills with SKILL.md

Your own skills in plain language

Three ways to create a skill

Every path ends in one OneDrive folder

- **Guided flow**: Customize > Add > Create skill with Cowork
- **Ask in chat**: describe the task you repeat
- **Write it yourself**: a `SKILL.md` in its own folder under `Documents/Cowork/Skills/`
- Cowork **discovers** your skills at the start of each conversation, up to 50
- **Upload** a `.md`, `.zip` or `.skill` file and share it with specific users



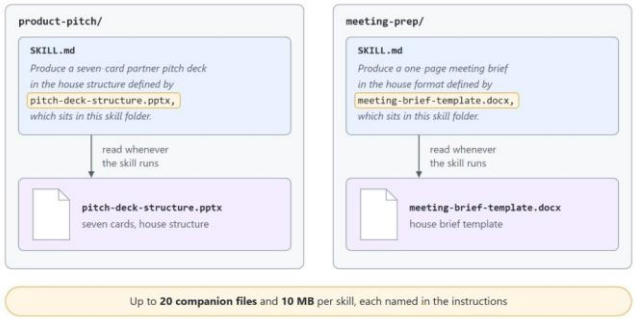
Anatomy of a SKILL.md

A YAML header plus plain-language instructions

- The **name** matches its folder, and the **description** is what Cowork reads to decide when the skill applies
- **Companion files** sit beside `SKILL.md`, up to 20 files and 10 MB, each named in

```
---
name: product-pitch
description: Turns a market brief, research report, or product document into a
wholesale partner pitch deck in Aurora Outdoor house structure, with every claim
traced back to a named source. Use whenever I say build a pitch, pitch this to
partners, turn this brief into a deck, or name a range or season to pitch.
---

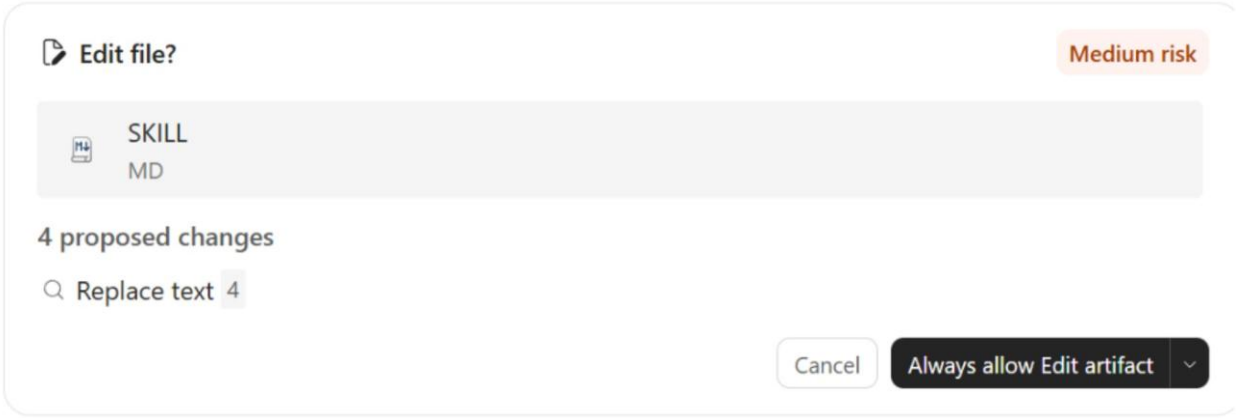
Produce a seven-card partner pitch deck in the house structure defined by pitch-
deck-structure.pptx, which sits in this skill folder.
```



Running and tuning a skill

From the first run to a skill that triggers on its own

- **Run it by name** in a new task, then check every claim against the source
- Ask which phrasings **miss the skill** and which instruction let weak claims through
- Cowork folds the fixes into `SKILL.md` through an **Edit file?** card at Medium risk
- The **Skill Report** scores the skill out of 100; 70 counts as ready to share
- Done when it **fires without being named** and saves Aurora Trail Capsule AW26.pptx



04

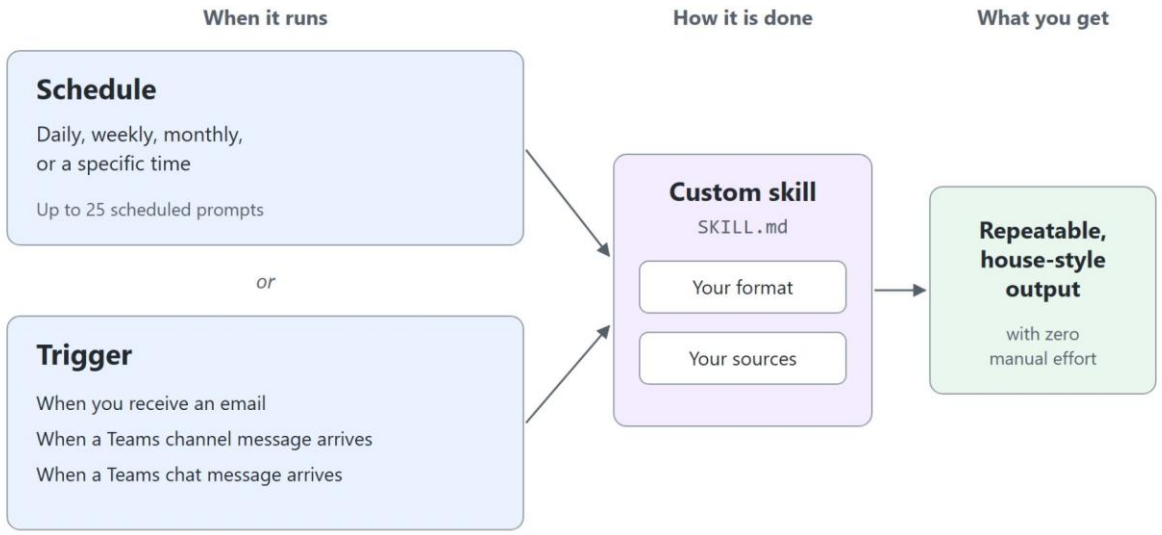
Scheduled Prompts & Event-Driven Tasks

On a schedule or when a message arrives

Schedules and triggers

Repeat a prompt on a cadence or when something happens

- A **schedule** repeats a prompt daily, weekly, monthly or at a set time, up to 25 of them
- A **trigger** starts the task when an email, a Teams channel message or a Teams chat message arrives
- The **Automations** page offers Add, templates such as Daily briefing, and the filters Scheduled, Triggers and Paused
- Each automation has an **Enable** switch and a … menu to edit, run now, pause or delete it
- The **custom skill** decides how the work is done; the schedule or trigger decides when



Good candidates for automation

Recurring reports and incoming messages

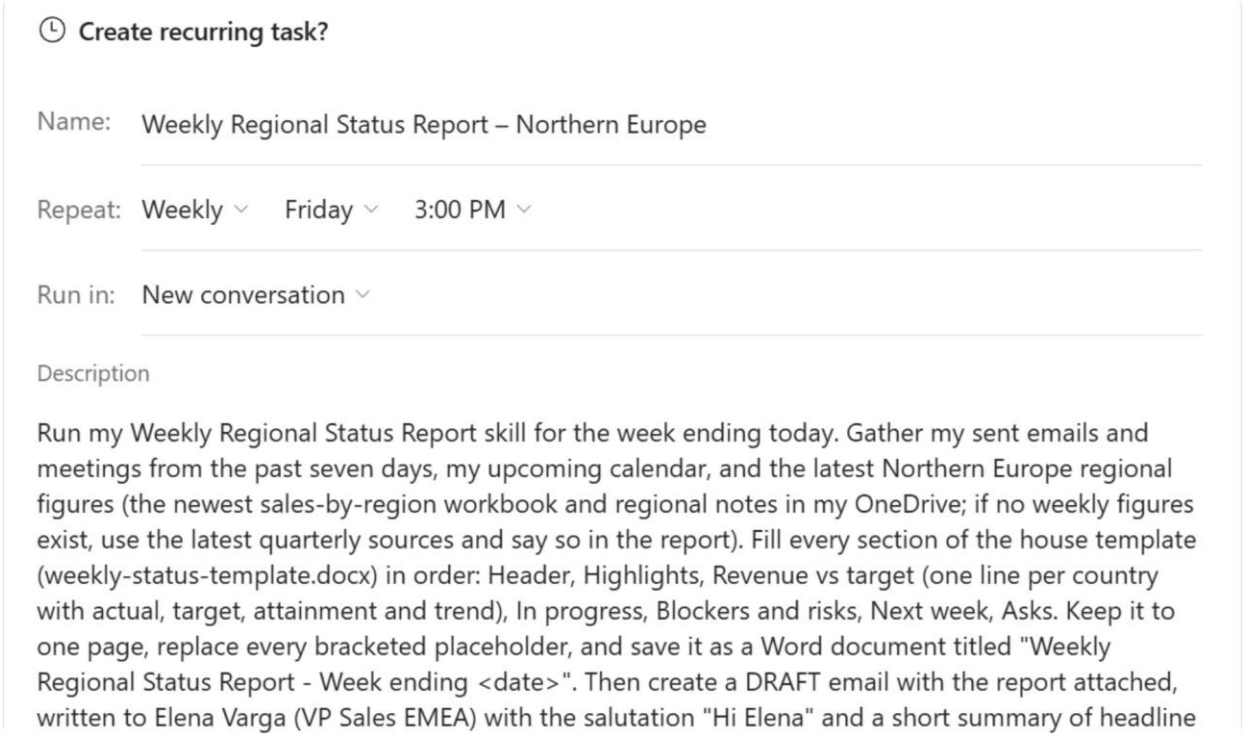
- Every weekday at 8 AM, a **Daily Briefing** of meetings, priority emails and newly shared documents
- Every Friday at 4 PM, a Word **status report** on your week for your manager
- On the first of the month, a one-page **digest** of the Marketing Teams channel
- When your manager emails about supplier delays, a **summary and draft reply** for your review
- When you are @mentioned in the Aurora Outdoor Operations channel, a **one-line summary** by email



Approvals in automated tasks

The weekly status report runs every Friday; the send waits for you

- **Create recurring task?** sets the name, Weekly, Friday, 3:00 PM, and a new conversation per run
- The **Description** is the prompt every run receives, including where the draft goes
- **Run once now** is ticked by default; clear it so the first run waits for Friday
- Each run leaves the report under Output and a **Hi Elena** email in your Drafts folder
- **Scheduling the run does not approve the send**: nothing leaves until you say so



05

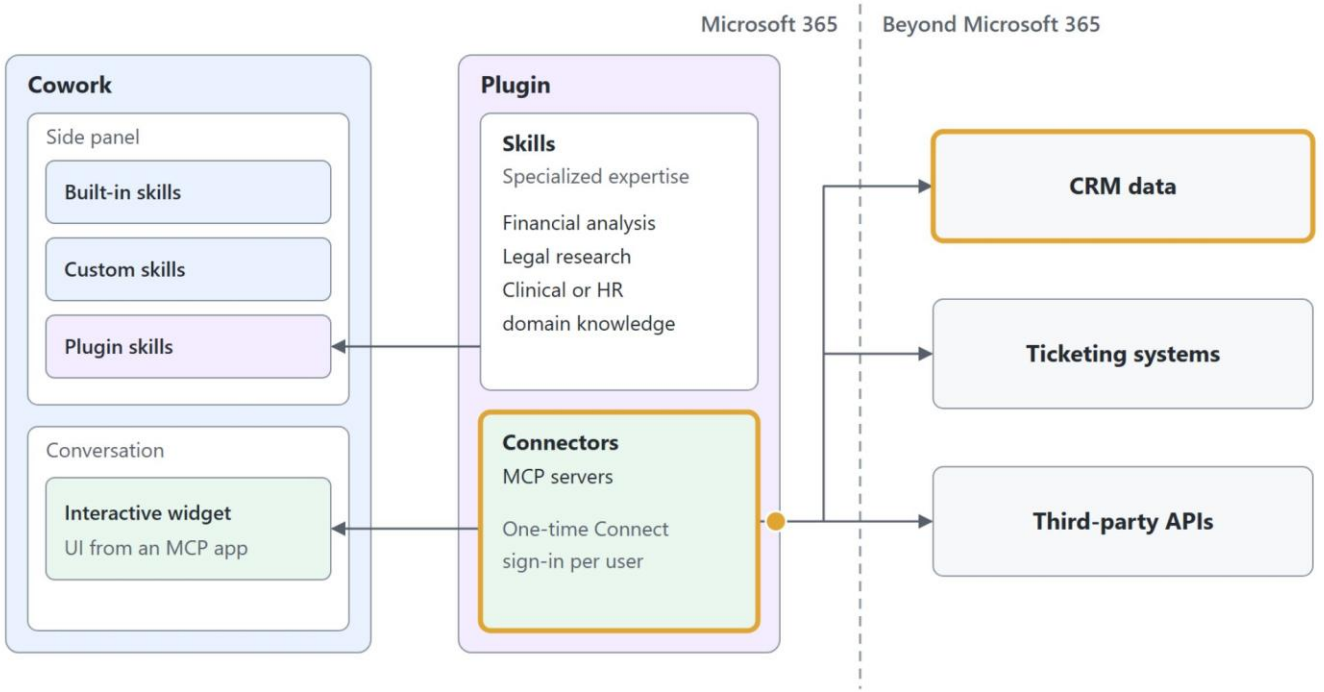
Extending Cowork with Plugins

Outside data and expertise from plugins

What plugins add

Skills and connectors that reach beyond Microsoft 365

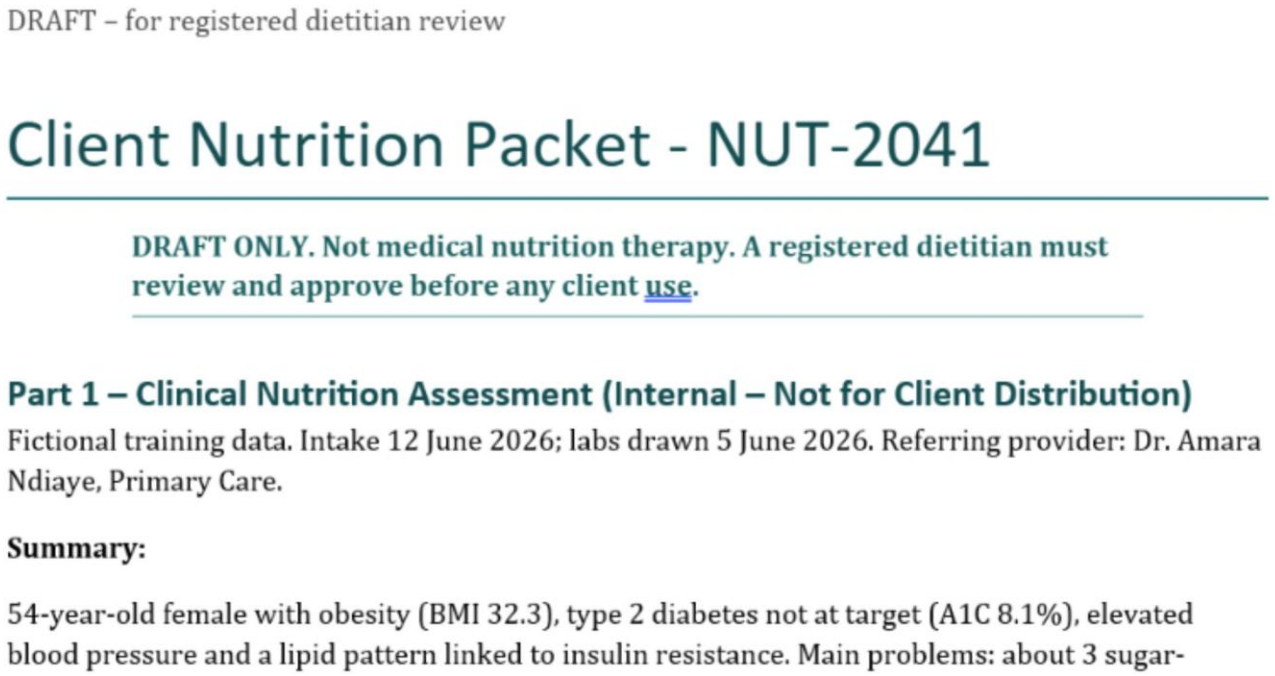
- Skills with **specialized expertise**: financial analysis, legal research, clinical or HR knowledge
- **MCP connectors** reach CRM data, ticketing systems and third-party APIs
- Each user completes a one-time **Connect** sign-in
- An **MCP app** returns an interactive widget into the conversation
- Plugins your admin rolls out show **Managed by your organization**



Where plugins fit

The dietitian plugin's skills beside the built-in Word skill

- **Upload** the dietitian package under Customize > Add > Upload and publish it to Only you
- Its skills **clinical-nutrition** and **dietary-communication** draft the assessment and the client handout
- Each loads with a **Reviewed custom skill** step and joins **Plugins** next to the built-in Word
- **Word** compiles both drafts into Client Nutrition Packet - NUT-2041, the DRAFT ONLY line on top
- Sharing with specific people needs **no admin**; the whole organization waits for admin approval



DRAFT – for registered dietitian review

Client Nutrition Packet - NUT-2041

DRAFT ONLY. Not medical nutrition therapy. A registered dietitian must review and approve before any client use.

Part 1 – Clinical Nutrition Assessment (Internal – Not for Client Distribution)

Fictional training data. Intake 12 June 2026; labs drawn 5 June 2026. Referring provider: Dr. Amara Ndiaye, Primary Care.

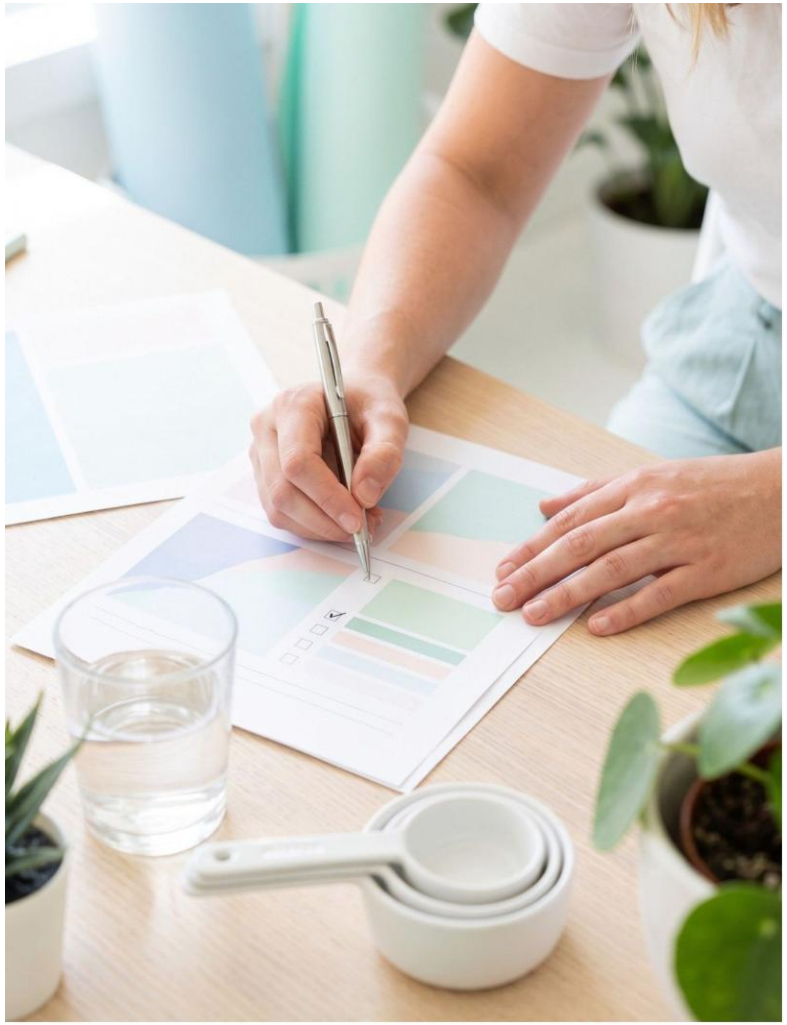
Summary:

54-year-old female with obesity (BMI 32.3), type 2 diabetes not at target (A1C 8.1%), elevated blood pressure and a lipid pattern linked to insulin resistance. Main problems: about 3 sugar-

Reviewing plugin output

The plugin drafts; the dietitian decides

A registered dietitian reviews and approves every packet before any of it reaches a client



06

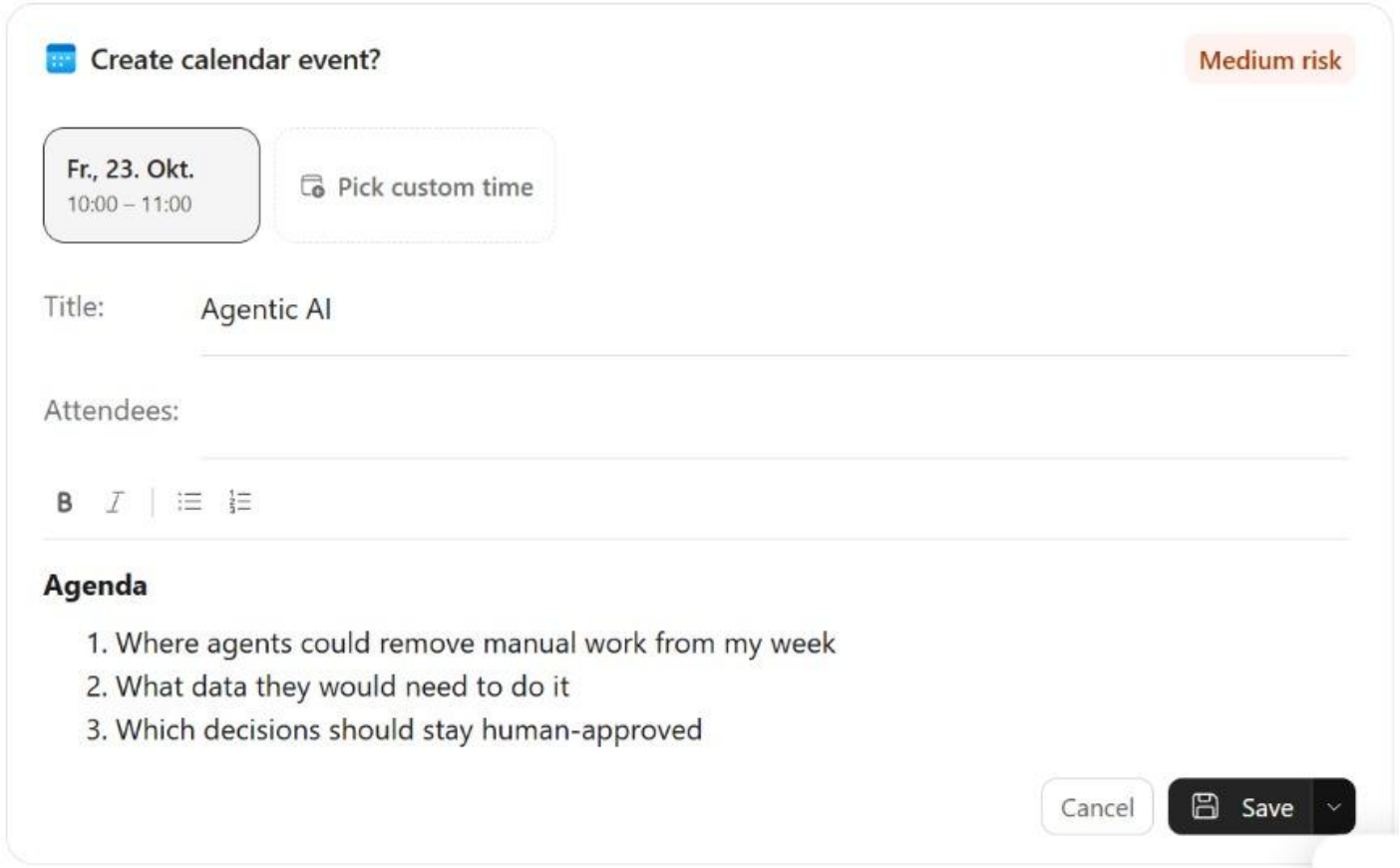
Human-in-the-Loop: Approving Actions & Staying in Control

Approvals, risk levels, and governance

The approval model

Cowork pauses before anything that leaves your workspace

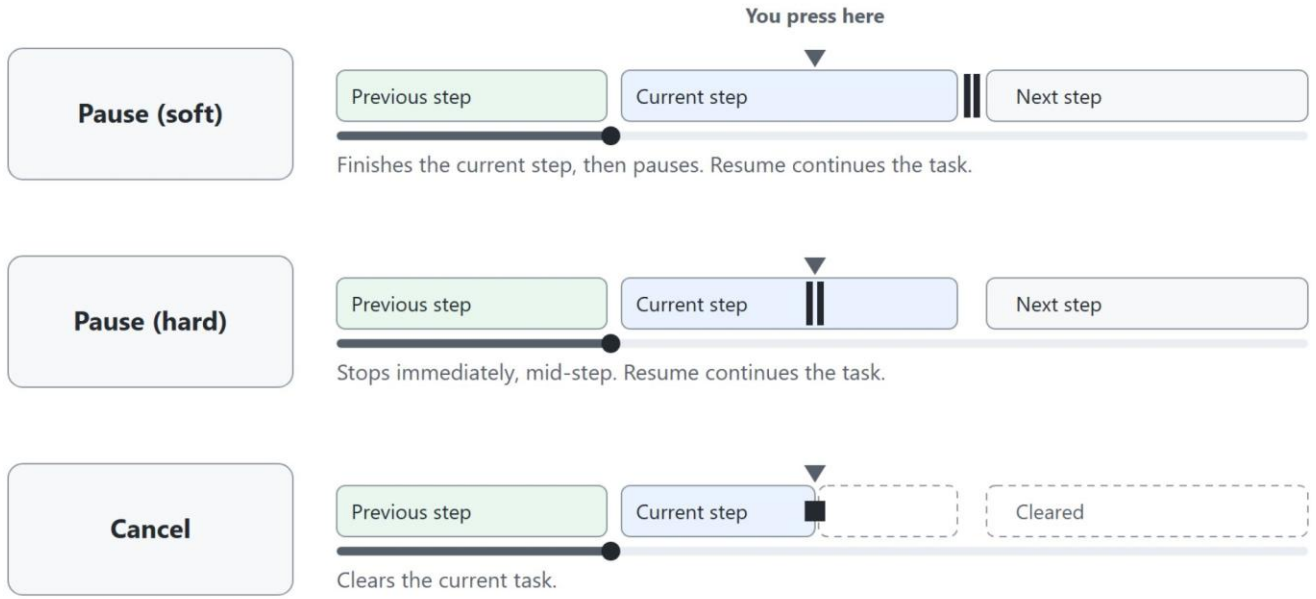
- The card names the action as a question, here **Create calendar event?**, and shows what it will write
- **Save** approves this one action, and the task records Approved 1 action
- The arrow beside it offers **Always allow Create event** for the rest of the session
- **Medium risk** changes your content or calendar; **high risk** reaches other people
- New files in Output and saved drafts need **no approval**



Steering an active task

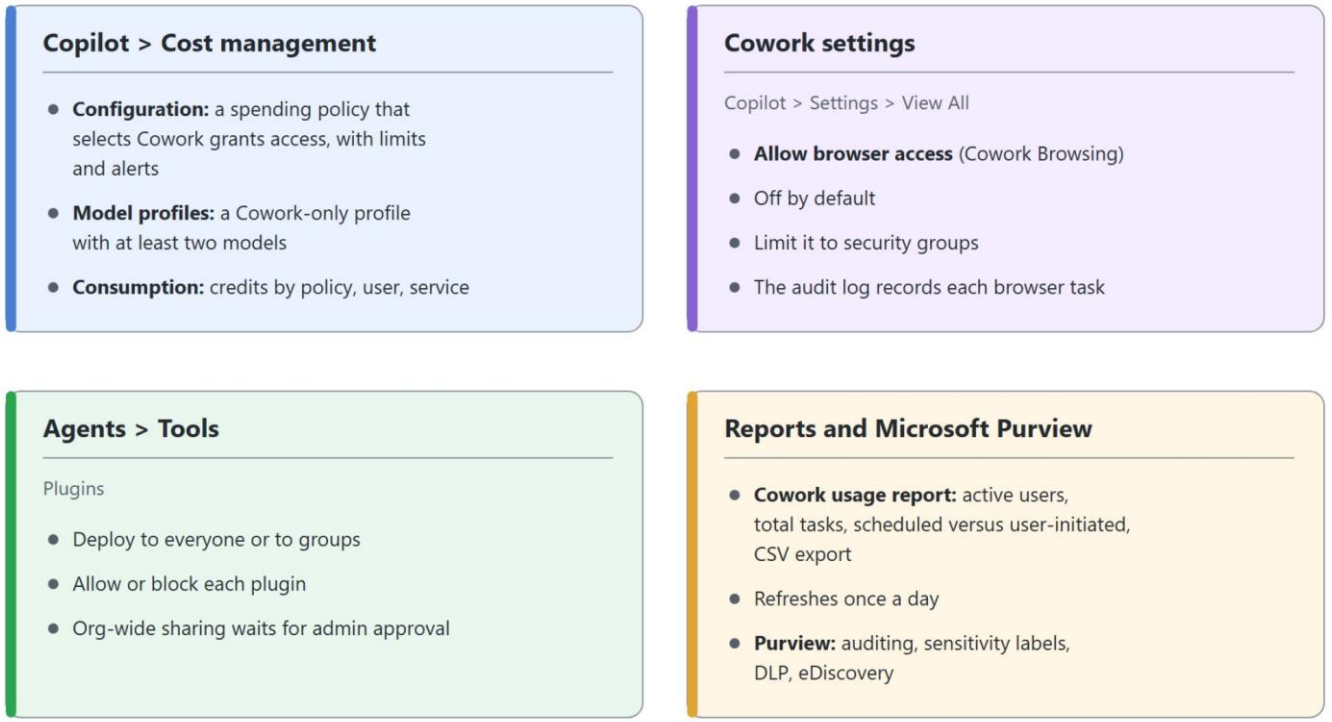
Pause, resume or cancel while Cowork works

- **Pause (soft)** finishes the current step, then pauses
- **Pause (hard)** stops immediately, mid-step
- **Resume** continues a paused task, Cancel clears the current one
- **Queued messages** sent while Cowork works can redirect it
- Rate responses and previewed documents with **thumbs up or down**, or comment inline



Governance for admins

Where each Cowork control lives



A **spending policy** grants access; browsing, plugins and reporting each have their own place in the admin center

Takeaways

From a first task to staying in control

- **Describe the outcome**, and Cowork plans and acts across Microsoft 365
- A **spending policy** that selects Cowork grants access, metered in Copilot Credits
- **Skills** load on their own, and a `SKILL.md` teaches Cowork one of your recurring jobs
- **Schedules, triggers and plugins** make the work recurring and bring in outside expertise
- **You approve** every send, booking and file edit before it leaves your workspace

